

ESG Quick-Scan — Sample Report

Preliminary Environmental, Social & Governance readiness scan

Prepared by Nikita Tsvetkov · Research & Analytics

Sample deliverable — methodology demonstrator

About this sample. This is a neutral demonstration of how I structure an ESG Quick-Scan deliverable. The subject — “*Meridian Foods*” — is a fictional mid-size food & beverage manufacturer (≈600 employees, exporting to the EU and APAC), used purely to show method, depth and formatting. A real engagement is tailored to your sector, your regions and your partners’ actual requirements. Every metric below is traceable to a named framework.

1. Executive takeaways

- **Three frameworks lead for this profile:** the EU **CSRD/ESRS** regime (because of EU market access), **ISSB IFRS S1/S2** (because APAC and investor partners increasingly reference it), and **GRI** as the universal disclosure backbone. SASB/TCFD content is absorbed into ISSB and does not need to be tracked separately.
- **Highest-priority gap:** no double-materiality assessment on file. Under ESRS this is the entry gate for every other disclosure — it should be the first commissioned step.
- **Climate is the binding metric set:** Scope 1–2 GHG inventory is achievable now; Scope 3 (purchased agricultural goods) is the material hotspot for this sector and the hardest data to source. Start Scope 3 category screening early.
- **Quick wins available in 1 quarter:** energy-use baseline, water-intensity metric, a board-level ESG ownership statement, and a supplier code of conduct — all low-cost, all expected by EU buyers.

2. ESG landscape for the sector

Framework	Why it applies here	Status for a mid-size exporter
EU CSRD / ESRS	EU market access; large EU customers cascade requirements down their supply	Likely in scope indirectly via buyers now, directly as thresholds phase in

Framework	Why it applies here	Status for a mid-size exporter
	chain	
ISSB IFRS S1 & S2	Global investor/partner baseline; adopted or endorsed across APAC	Becoming the default “common language” for climate + sustainability
GRI Standards	Universal multi-stakeholder disclosure; GRI 13 covers agriculture/food	Practical reporting backbone; widely recognised by buyers
TCFD	Climate risk governance & scenario logic	Now folded into ISSB S2 — adopt via S2, don’t run separately
CDP	Disclosure & benchmarking channel large buyers request	Often the <i>form</i> in which EU customers ask for your data
EU Taxonomy	Defines “environmentally sustainable” activity for EU finance/partners	Relevant if seeking green finance or EU-aligned procurement

Reading: for an EU-facing manufacturer the practical stack is **ESRS for compliance, ISSB for the investor/partner language, GRI for the disclosure structure, CDP as the buyer-facing channel**. Everything else maps into these four.

3. Material topics & priority metrics

Prioritised on a simple *impact × likelihood-of-being-asked* basis. “Target view” states what credible peers report against.

Environmental

Metric	Framework anchor	Target view
Scope 1 & 2 GHG emissions (tCO ₂ e)	ESRS E1 / ISSB S2 / GHG Protocol	Disclosed annually, market- & location-based
Scope 3 — purchased goods (agri inputs)	ESRS E1 / GHG Protocol Cat. 1	Screened & estimated; hotspot categories quantified
Energy consumption & mix (MWh, % renewable)	ESRS E1	Baseline + renewable-share trajectory

Metric	Framework anchor	Target view
Water withdrawal & intensity (m ³ / unit)	ESRS E3	Tracked at high-water-stress sites
Waste & packaging recyclability (%)	ESRS E5	Diversion rate + recyclable-packaging %

Social

Metric	Framework anchor	Target view
Recordable injury rate (TRIR/LTIFR)	ESRS S1 / GRI 403	Disclosed; trending down
Gender split & pay-gap (%)	ESRS S1 / GRI 405	Workforce + management breakdown
Supply-chain labour standards	ESRS S2 / GRI 414	Supplier code + audit coverage %
Food safety / product quality incidents	GRI 416	Incident count + recall record

Governance

Metric	Framework anchor	Target view
Board ESG oversight	ESRS G1 / ISSB S1	Named board-level owner of sustainability
Business-ethics & anti-corruption	ESRS G1 / GRI 205	Policy + training coverage %
Double-materiality assessment	ESRS (foundational)	Completed and refreshed annually

4. Peer benchmark — how leaders frame it

Distilled patterns from how listed sector leaders structure their reporting (illustrative):

1. **Double-materiality first.** Leaders publish a materiality matrix up front and tie every subsequent metric back to it — it is the spine of an ESRS-aligned report.
2. **Climate gets its own chapter.** Scope 1/2/3 + a transition plan with interim targets (not just a distant net-zero date) is now table stakes.
3. **Scope 3 honesty wins trust.** Best-in-class disclose Scope 3 *with* a stated data-quality caveat rather than omitting it — buyers reward transparency over false precision.

4. **One report, multiple frameworks.** A single sustainability statement mapped to ESRS, indexed to GRI, and cross-walked to ISSB — not three separate documents.
5. **Targets are quantified and dated.** Vague commitments are discounted; SBTi-validated or numerically bounded targets are highlighted.

5. Compliance snapshot & readiness

Area	On the horizon	Readiness (illustrative)
Double-materiality assessment	ESRS prerequisite	● Not started — commission first
Scope 1 & 2 inventory	ESRS E1 / ISSB S2	● Data exists, not consolidated
Scope 3 screening	ESRS E1	● Agri inputs unquantified
Supplier code of conduct	ESRS S2	● Partial — formalise & roll out
Board ESG ownership	ESRS G1	● Quick win — assign + minute it
CDP response capability	Buyer-requested	● Feasible once GHG baseline set

Recommended sequence: (1) double-materiality assessment → (2) Scope 1-2 baseline → (3) Scope 3 category screening → (4) supplier code + board ownership (parallel quick wins) → (5) first ESRS-indexed sustainability statement.

Methodology note: this scan is built entirely from public, authoritative frameworks (GRI, ISSB/IFRS, GHG Protocol, EU CSRD/ESRS, EU Taxonomy, CDP, SBTi). No paid databases are required. Where a real engagement needs proprietary peer data or live interviews, that scope and any data costs are flagged to the client up front.